

Manual for Procurement of APIs, Excipients, Consumables, Spares, and Instruments

Pharmaceutical Manufacturing Plant (Nigeria)

1. Introduction & Purpose

- Define procurement's role: ensuring only approved, quality-compliant raw materials, consumables, spares, and instruments are sourced for pharmaceutical production.
- Scope: APIs, excipients, consumables (filters, reagents, packaging), spare parts, laboratory instruments, and production equipment.
- Alignment: **NAFDAC GMP**, **PCN requirements**, and **WHO GMP**.

2. Regulatory Framework

- **NAFDAC**: All APIs and excipients must be from approved suppliers; imported materials require permits.
- **PCN**: Procurement of APIs requires supervision of a registered pharmacist.
- **WHO GMP**: Supplier qualification and material traceability are mandatory.

3. Procurement Principles

- Ensure transparency, accountability, and compliance with GMP.
- Procurement only from **approved vendors** on the *Approved Supplier List (ASL)*.
- All suppliers must pass a **Supplier Qualification Program** (evaluation of GMP compliance, certificates of analysis, and audit where necessary).

4. Responsibilities

- **Head of Procurement**: Oversees purchasing activities, reports to Plant Manager.
- **Head of QA/QC**: Approves new suppliers and materials.
- **Warehouse Manager**: Verifies incoming materials against procurement documentation.
- **Finance Department**: Ensures payments only to approved suppliers.

5. Supplier Qualification & Approval

- Documentation required: GMP certificate, Certificate of Analysis (CoA), ISO certification (where available).
- For APIs/excipients: supplier audit or questionnaire evaluation.
- Approved suppliers maintained in **Approved Supplier List (ASL)** updated annually.

6. Procurement Process (Simplified Flow)

1. **Material Request** raised by production or QC.
2. **Review & Approval** by QA and Procurement Manager.
3. **Vendor Selection** from ASL.
4. **Purchase Order (PO)** issued to supplier.
5. **Delivery & Receipt** at warehouse.
6. **QC Sampling & Testing** before material release.
7. **Final Approval/Quarantine/Reject** decision by QA.

7. APIs & Excipients Procurement

- Importation permits from NAFDAC mandatory.
- Ensure **traceability of batch numbers, CoAs, and origin**.
- Store under defined conditions (temperature, humidity).

8. Consumables & Spares Procurement

- Includes: filters, reagents, glassware, gaskets, spare parts for machines.
- Must meet GMP quality standards and supplier must demonstrate traceability.

9. Instruments & Equipment Procurement

- Vendors must provide calibration certificates, user manuals, and service support.
- Preference for GMP-compliant equipment validated for pharmaceutical use.

10. Documentation & Records

- Maintain procurement records: request forms, POs, invoices, supplier approvals, CoAs, import permits.
- Procurement files archived per GMP documentation policy (minimum 5 years).

11. Risk Management in Procurement

- Dual sourcing of critical APIs to avoid stockouts.
- Risk assessment of new suppliers.
- Contingency plans for delayed shipments or supplier failure.

12. Annexes (Concise Templates)

- **Annex A:** Approved Supplier List (ASL) format.
- **Annex B:** Supplier Qualification Checklist.
- **Annex C:** Procurement Request Form.
- **Annex D:** Goods Receipt Verification Form.